

The 2020 Problem

How Command Center Studios handles any Morphin Grid Universe film dated in 2020, based on when its release date falls relative to the COVID-19 theater shutdowns.

THE SLATE STRUCTURE

Phase	Window	Films
Phase 1	2013–2017	6
Phase 2	2018–2020	6
Phase 3	2021–2024	11
The Zordon Saga	2013–2024	23

No titles or specific dates are set here. The films get built later; this memo only sets the rules for whatever lands in 2020.

THE RULING

Delay, don't dump. Every MGU film stays theatrical-first.

The deciding factor is the date. Anything that opens before the shutdown goes out as planned. Anything dated after it moves to theaters in mid-2021. No MGU film goes to streaming as its first release, and no film gets cut down, re-edited or rushed through VFX to keep a 2020 date. Delivering a weakened film would break the no-nerf mandate as surely as weakening a character would.

RULES BY RELEASE WINDOW

Release date	What happens	Why
Jan 1 – Feb 28, 2020	Release as dated, worldwide except China.	U.S. theaters were still open. <i>Sonic the Hedgehog</i> opened to \$58M on February 14. Chinese cinemas closed on January 23, so drop the China date and release there later.
Feb 28 – Mar 12, 2020	Keep the release, then move to digital and Disney+ early once theaters close.	Pixar's <i>Onward</i> (March 6) played nine days before closures, went to digital on March 20 and reached Disney+ on April 3. A film already in theaters can't be pulled, so it should get to home audiences quickly.
Mar 13 – Dec 31, 2020	Pull the date and move to an exclusive theatrical release in summer 2021.	U.S. theaters closed around March 16–17. New York and Los Angeles, the two biggest markets, stayed closed until March 2021, which is why <i>Tenet</i> stalled in the U.S. even with most theaters reopened. A late-2020 date doesn't help.

WHY NOT DISNEY+ PREMIER ACCESS OR DAY-AND-DATE?

Because 2020 and 2021 showed what it costs.

- *Mulan* skipped theaters for a \$29.99 Disney+ Premier Access release in September 2020 and never had a real box office run. A Zordon Saga chapter deserves better.
- *Black Widow* released in theaters and on Disney+ on the same day in July 2021. It dropped off quickly, and Scarlett Johansson sued Disney over lost box office bonuses. Releasing the same way would expose our cast to the same dispute.
- *Spider-Man: No Way Home* made about \$1.9B worldwide in December 2021 with an exclusive theatrical release. Audiences came back for event films, and the Phase 2 finale should get that kind of release.

THE KNOCK-ON EFFECT

Phase 2 runs into 2021, and Phase 3 still ends in 2024.

- **Phases are defined by story, not by year.** Phase 2's delayed films stay in Phase 2 and release in their original order. Continuity comes before the calendar.
- **Phase 2's window becomes 2018–2021.** The delayed films take the May–July 2021 window, after New York and Los Angeles reopened and vaccines were widely available.
- **Phase 3 keeps all 11 films and still ends in 2024.** It starts in late 2021 once Phase 2 is finished, then runs at about three films a year through 2024. That's the same pace Marvel kept up in 2021 (four films) and matched in 2022–2023.

PRODUCTION DURING THE SHUTDOWN

Shoot in New Zealand, where the show has filmed since 2003.

- Power Rangers TV production moved to New Zealand with *Ninja Storm* in 2003, so the crews, stages and know-how are already there.
- New Zealand brought COVID under control early, and productions such as the *Avatar* sequels resumed filming there by June 2020, months ahead of Hollywood. MGU films can finish shooting on time without cutting their scale.
- VFX houses kept working remotely through 2020. Zords and Megazords stay full-scale, and no shot gets downgraded to make a date.

This is a fictional, alternate-history development document created for creative purposes. Real films, people, companies and dates are cited as historical reference and don't imply any real involvement or endorsement.